

They hadn't planned on expanding their family so quickly, and the extra mouths to feed and clothe had strained the family's finances. It hadn't helped that Patty's income was lost after she decided to stay home full-time with the children.

By paying only for the essentials, they tried to make ends meet. This meant giving up the "fun" from their budget. Even after they eliminated the "fun," they still needed to cut out more. They decided that they would discontinue paying for life insurance for themselves. They just couldn't afford it anymore and besides, it really wasn't absolutely necessary. Since they were both young, what were the odds that they would die soon?

It turned out that their bet didn't pay off. Andrew was the victim of a hit and run accident and died on the scene. Patty was still in shock over Andrew's death when she received the additional shock of the cost of the funeral. There was no way she could pay for it. Since they had stopped paying for their life insurance, there was no policy to collect. Andrew was self-employed, so she didn't even have the possibility of collecting a company death benefit.

Patty's parents ended up paying for the funeral, and this payment became the first of their many payments to Patty's creditors. Unable to leave her children after the tragedy, Patty couldn't work and ended up on welfare. The welfare payments were much lower than Andrew's wages and she found herself unable to pay her living expenses. Faced with no other option, she moved back in with her parents.

This proved to be a hardship to everyone involved, since her parents had downsized their home after Patty and her brothers had married and left home. Her parents now lived in a small two-bedroom house. Patty was forced to share the second bedroom with her two children. One benefit of living with her parents was that her mother could watch her children during the day, which allowed Patty to start working at

